

Healing Champions: HOSMAT's Role in Cricket's Biggest Matches

DR. THOMAS CHANDY

The roar of the crowd, the thrill of a winning six, the agony of a crucial injury, these are the emotions that course through the veins of cricket. For the players on the field, the pressure is immense. But behind the scenes, another battle is waged. The fight to keep these gladiators in top form. HOSMAT, the Hospital for Orthopaedics, Sports Medicine, Arthroscopy/Arthroplasty, and Accident Trauma is that silent guardian making sure our cricketers stay in their best form.

Since 1993, this Bengaluru institution has been synonymous with healing cricketing heroes. From the hallowed turf of Chinnaswamy Stadium to the high-tech treatment rooms of HOSMAT, the journey of recovery unfolds.

A Partnership for Peak Performance

Recognizing the growing need for specialized sports medicine in India, the hospital's founders joined hands with the Karnataka State Cricket Association to become the official medical care provider for international matches. This collaboration ensures that when injuries strike on



Dr Thomas Chandy, founder of HOSMAT Hospital, is an experienced Orthopaedic Surgeon (American Board Certified) trained in New York. He has fellowships in Sports Medicine, Arthroscopy and Joint replacement from University of Oklahoma, US, followed by being chief of orthopaedics in Tulsa, Oklahoma for 10 years and has worked in the US for 16 years.

VVS Laxman, Mithali Raj and Gautam Gambhir are just a few to have received care at HOSMAT's facilities. International stars like Andrew Flintoff, Lance Klusener, Mohammad Hussain, Shoaib Akhtar, and Bangladesh's heroes like Shakib Al Hasan and Mushfiquir Rahim have also entrusted their well-being to the hospital's expertise. This diverse clientele is a testament to HOSMAT's reputation for excellence in sports medicine.

HOSMAT's success hinges on meticulous preparation beyond just having a well-trained staff. Located just minutes from the stadium, the hospital ensures the crucial golden hour for treatment is never missed. Advanced diagnostics like MRI, CT scans, and X-rays are readily available, providing doctors with a clear picture of the injury for swift diagnosis. The team itself boasts an impressive roster - 15 orthopaedic specialists, 20 visiting surgeons, and 2 neurosurgeons, all working together to get players back on their feet, fast.

The Science and Art of Healing

But healing goes beyond high-tech equipment. The state-of-the-art physiotherapy department is a haven for injured players, employing the latest techniques to rebuild

strength, flexibility and endurance specific to the sport. From muscle strains to ligament tears, the physiotherapists work tirelessly to get players match-fit, incorporating targeted exercises and rehabilitation programs. This comprehensive approach ensures a complete recovery, allowing players to return to the field at their peak performance.

Physiotherapy Tailored for Cricket

The enthusiastic roar of the crowd can sometimes lead to sprained ankles or the occasional bump on the head for spectators caught in the throes of celebration. The team is there to ensure everyone enjoys the game safely. A team of 12 medical personnel is stationed near the boundary line during matches, ready to respond to any emergencies in the stands. They also provide 2 Advanced Cardiac Life Support Ambulances (ACLS) specifically for players, that are manned by one trained paramedic along with a qualified nurse and a driver to ensure safe and enjoyable experience.

HOSMAT's Legacy in Cricket

From the electrifying 1996 World Cup quarter-final between India and Pakistan to the historic 2011 World Cup and the most recent edition in 2023, HOSMAT has been present, ensuring the smooth flow of the game. The hospital has also provided medical services for other major matches and national football tournaments, solidifying its position as a leading provider of sports medicine in India.

The satisfaction of witnessing a player recover and return to the field is immeasurable. HOSMAT plays a vital role in this journey. The hospital is a silent partner in those magical moments on the field, the unseen force that keeps the game going. So, the next time you witness a breath-taking catch or a lightning-fast delivery, remember, there's a team behind the scenes. At HOSMAT, the unwavering dedication to healing the champions who make it all so special is matched only by the team's passion for cricket.



the field, a world-class medical team is at hand, ready to respond with expertise and efficiency.

A Team Ready for Any Crisis

Imagine the adrenaline surging through the veins of the HOSMAT staff during a high-stakes match. The Players' Medical Room (PMR) at Chinnaswamy transforms into a mini-hospital, staffed by a dedicated team of professionals. On the match day 5 staff are on the ground near the boundary line to attend emergencies. Orthopaedic and emergency medicine consultants, an anaesthetist, nurses, and paramedics - all stand ready to respond to any medical crisis.

A Global Clientele

Indian stalwarts like MS Dhoni, Virat Kohli, Rohit Sharma, Jasprit Bumrah,

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